FREE TOOL · 18 CHECKS · 5 MINUTES

The Factory AI *Readiness Checklist*

Before you spend money on AI, check whether the problem — and your factory — is ready for a small trial. Tick what's true today. Be honest; the unticked boxes are your to-do list.

The problem we're checking

e.g. Machines stop without warning on Line 2

Who owns it

e.g. Maintenance head

1 Is the problem worth solving?

Pick one problem first. Everything below is about that one problem.

- [ ] We can name one problem that costs us money or time every month.
- [ ] It happens often — every week, not once a year.
- [ ] We can roughly say what it costs us: hours, wasted material, late orders or lost customers.
- [ ] One person owns this problem and wants it fixed.
- [ ] We've already tried the simple fix (a checklist, a clearer rule, a better form).

2 Do we have the records?

AI learns from examples. Paper, WhatsApp and spreadsheets all count.

- [ ] The work is written down somewhere — software, a spreadsheet, WhatsApp or paper.
- [ ] We have at least 6–12 months of these records.
- [ ] Items, machines and customers are named the same way each time.
- [ ] We can get the records out — as an export, photos or scans.
- [ ] We know which of our records are unreliable or often missing.

3 Are our people ready?

The best AI projects are built with the people who do the work.

- [ ] We've asked the people who do this work what goes wrong and why.
- [ ] Someone will check the AI's suggestions before anyone acts on them.
- [ ] The team can give a few hours a week to a trial.
- [ ] We've told the team openly what will change — and what won't.

4 Are we set up to test it fairly?

A small, measured trial beats a big promise.

- [ ] We know which software we use (Tally, ERP, Excel) and who looks after it.
- [ ] We've checked whether our current software can already do this.
- [ ] We've set a small budget and a time limit for a trial — about 4 to 8 weeks.
- [ ] We've agreed how we'll measure the result before and after.

Score yourself

Count your ticks.

0–7 **Not yet — fix the basics first.** Start by choosing one costly problem, giving it an owner, and recording it properly for a few weeks. That alone often pays off.

8–13 **Getting there.** You have a real problem and some records. Fill the gaps below, then plan a small trial on one machine, line or document type.

14–18 **Ready for a small trial.** You're ready to test AI on this problem. Keep it small, measure before and after, and keep a person in charge of decisions.

Made by Nayansi Jain · AI consultant for manufacturers · ainayansi@gmail.com · Instagram @nayansiai